

Corsair's vengeance gaming

Corsair is hosting an online Call of Duty 4 tournament with a \$10,000 prize pool
<http://bit.ly/rhrif3>

Greatest graphics cards ever

Tomshardware has compiled a list of graphics card that were the best in the business all the way from '95
<http://bit.ly/rdK4IF>

Graphics Cards Test

gaming. But for an HTPC setup, they make the ideal choice. There are around six cards in this category from various brands based on the Caicos CPU (for AMD cards) and the GF 119 GPU (for NVIDIA cards). All the HD 6450s (XFX, PowerColor, Galaxy and Sapphire) were of the half-height form factor and barring PowerColor every one came with the

LP bracket included. Heatsinks on all the cards were passive ones with the Galaxy HD 6450 having a heatsink with comparatively more fins and an extension on the left-hand side of the card. Forza GeForce GT 520 and Sparkle GeForce GT 520 are also half-height form factor cards but they sport a small fan along with the passive heatsink. Considering their low power profile, all the cards are at reference settings. The HD 6450 and GT 520 cards that we got all had the slightly older DDR3 memory.

Performance

The gaming scores weren't that promising. GeForce GT 520 cards performed better than HD 6450 in most of the

benchmarks. The only game that seemed remotely playable at present settings was *Dirt 3*, with the GT 520 touching 25 fps at 1280x1024, Medium settings. On going lower, you'll get better frame-rates. Forza GT 520 was the coolest among all the cards on load, whereas the passive coolers on the HD 6450s were better than the fans of Galaxy GT 520 and Sparkle GT 520. As far as 3D Mark 11 was concerned only two cards crossed 1000 marks. *Crysis Warhead* is not playable at 1280x1024 on these cards. *Resident Evil 5* and *FarCry 2* are playable with the GT 520s on resolutions of 1024x768 and below.

Winners

We had a wonderful time testing out the cards and each category

had a lot of surprises to look forward to. Many categories had similar chipsets, which made the fight really close between the best of them.

ZOTAC GTX 560 Ti AMP Edition emerged as the overall Best Performer thanks to its supreme scores in all the benchmarks. This has got a lot to do with the factory over-clock. At 950MHz, it is around 130 MHz overlocked from the reference settings. This also leads to a lot of heating. EVGA GTX 560 Ti was factory overlocked as well but its core clock was 25MHz slower than the ZOTAC card, thus giving scores close to the Best Performer.

Asus GTX 560 won the Best Buy as it gave a 92 percent performance to price ratio which



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